

either people who are asking to borrow it or, more often, when those close to you have a bigger budget and higher expectations for things like nights out, weddings and group trips. This can be even more intense in romantic partnerships where one person earns more than the other. For a very long time this stumped me, because wanting to please people and be perceived as likeable was my own Achilles heel – how could I advise others to ‘just say no’ when it was something that I struggled with myself? I wasn’t very well-versed in how to set boundaries, which is something that I’ve spent a lot of time working on over the last year. Around the time when *Real Life Money* was published and I felt my boundaries crumble like a misjudged Bake-Off showstopper, I discovered therapist Nedra Glover Tawwab on Instagram.⁶ She is a boundaries expert, and when her first book, *Set Boundaries, Find Peace*,⁷ was published in 2021, I was keen to get my hands on it. From the first few pages, it resonated so deeply with me that it felt almost like a violent attack. I realized just how deep-seated my own boundary issues were – even the ones that I’d already begun to work on – and the ripple effect that they were having on so much of my life. I saw clearly how responsible my failure to commit to and communicate healthy boundaries was for the burn-out I was experiencing, and the creeping resentment that I was feeling. I knew that I couldn’t hope to protect my growing sense of financial wellbeing without introducing new boundaries and strengthening the ones that I already had in place – that if I didn’t do this work then my financial